

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Stressed out!



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about solving problems.
- I can express necessity, duty, and advice.
- I can report facts about events or actions.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you feel stress in your life?
- What causes stress?
- What are some things that you can do to reduce stress?





Let's Explore!

Kristi reads an article about **getting a handle on*** stress.

* "To get a handle on" something means to get it under control.

3.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

8 Proven Ways to Minimize Stress and Limit its Health Effects

1. You Should Think Positively
Research has shown that optimism or pessimism affects your quality of life. Optimistic thinking helps you to cope with stressful situations and minimize the effects that stress can have on your body.
2. You Had Better Change Your Emotional Response
Positive strategies which deal with stress help avoid negative consequences. You ought to think about stress as a reaction to a problem, rather than the problem itself.
3. Remember to Protect Your Time
Some people find it hard to refuse requests which are made of their time. Agreeing to do everything comes at a price — less peace of mind and more stress. You need to do things you enjoy and not feel guilty about it.
4. Restore Work-Life Balance
Stress is created when your work life and personal life feel out of balance.
5. You Should Try Meditation
Meditation can reduce your stress by calming your mind. Concentration meditation is when you focus your attention on one thing, like an image you visualize or your breathing.
6. You've Got to Keep Your Cool
Focus on how you can gain control of a situation. There are four ways to help manage stress: adapt, alter, avoid, or accept!
7. You Need to Maintain a Solid Social Network
A solid social support network is a group of friends, family and peers who can help you through periods of stress. A social support network is best developed when you're not under stress. This provides the comfort of knowing you have friends when you need them.



Let's Practice!

Kristi reads an article about stress management.

Instruction: Circle the correct modal verb that express necessity.

1. You _____ positively.
 - may think
 - should think
 - might thinks
2. You _____ about stress as your reaction to an event.
 - are think
 - ought to think
 - would to think
3. You _____ time for yourself without feeling guilty.
 - need to take
 - might taken
 - could takes



Let's Practice!

Let's see what the article says about stress.

Instructions: Choose the words from the word bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

network / manage / optimism / reduce / negative / techniques

1. Studies indicate that _____ or pessimism affects your quality of life.
2. Positive strategies which deal with stress help avoid _____ consequences.
3. There are different types of meditation _____ that can calm your mind and _____ your stress.
4. A strong social support _____ is made up of friends, family and peers who can help you through periods of stress.
5. There are four ways to help _____ stress: avoid, alter, adapt or accept!





Extension Activity

Make a plan to reduce stress.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, brainstorm all the ways you can reduce stress in your life.
- On your own, choose 10 of your ideas and put them in order from most effective to least effective.
- Write a short description for each tip.
- Compare your list with your partner. Do you have many differences in your lists?

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I brainstorm ways to reduce stress.

☐ ☐

I make a list of tips for reducing stress.

☐ ☐

I put my list in order from most effective to least effective.

☐ ☐

I compare my list with my partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to restore** (verb): to return something or someone to an earlier good condition or position
e.g. Restore work-life balance.
- meditation** (noun): the act of giving your attention to only one thing as a way of becoming calm and relaxed
e.g. Meditation can reduce your stress by calming your mind.
- to minimize** (verb): to make less
e.g. Optimistic thinking helps you to cope with stressful situations and minimize the effect that stress can have on your body.
- optimism** (noun): the quality of being full of hope and a belief that something good will happen
e.g. Research has shown that optimism or pessimism affects your quality of life.
- to visualize** (verb): to form a picture of someone or something in your mind, in order to imagine it
e.g. Concentration meditation is when you focus your attention on one thing, like an image you visualize or your breathing.
- to alter** (verb): to change something, usually slightly, or to cause the characteristics of something to change
e.g. There are four ways that can help manage stress: avoid, alter, adapt or accept!
- to keep your cool** (expression): to remain calm
e.g. You've got to keep your cool.





Learning Points

Relative Clauses

You use relative clauses to make your writing and speaking more detailed and sophisticated. A defining clause gives essential information about a noun. A non-defining clause gives additional information about a noun.

In relative clauses, you use *who* for people, *that* or *which* for things, *when* with time and *where* with places.

Defining Clause:

People **who talk too much** annoy me a lot.

Without the clause "who talk too much", the meaning of the sentence changes:
People annoy me a lot.

Non-defining Clause:

My younger sister, **who is really shy**, rarely speaks to anyone.

Without the clause "who is really shy" the main idea of the sentence stays the same. You need to use commas to keep the non-defining clause separate from the rest of the sentence.

Look at some examples from the dialogue:

Examples:

- *Research has shown that optimism or pessimism affects your quality of life.*
- *Positive strategies which deal with stress help avoid negative consequences.*
- *There are different types of meditation techniques that can calm your mind and reduce your stress.*
- *A solid social support network is a group of friends, family and peers who can help you through periods of stress.*
- *There are four ways to help manage stress: avoid, alter, adapt or accept!*





Learning Points

Stress Management Tips

Some workplace stress is normal. However, a lot of stress interferes with your workflow and influences your health, both physically and emotionally. Your ability to cope with it can make a big difference in your success at work.

There are many things you can't control at your work, but there are things you can do. You don't need to make huge changes or rethink career ambitions. Try focus on the one things within your control: you.

Read the following tips to manage workplace stress:

Examples:

- *You should think positively.*
- *You had better change your emotional response.*
- *You ought to think about stress as a reaction to a problem, rather than the problem itself.*
- *You need to do things you enjoy and not feel guilty about it.*
- *You should try meditation.*
- *You've got to keep your cool.*
- *You need to maintain a strong social network.*

